

**David Buchanan**

Delivery Lead

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Professional Summary

Release Train Engineer & Scrum Master with over 15 years of experience delivering complex projects. I focus on building delivery systems that actually work taking high-level strategy and turning it into predictable, reliable execution. Throughout my career, I've moved from managing team-level delivery to architecting organization-wide Agile frameworks. My approach is simple: I standardize the mess, clear the blockers, and use data to show where we can improve. At Airbus alone I've led the delivery of over 11,000 user stories and 1,200 production deployments. I streamlined PI planning to cut event time by 66% while hitting an 86% objective completion rate. I'm at my best when I'm connecting leadership strategy with team reality, ensuring that teams have a clear path to deliver value without the usual corporate friction.

Professional Skills

Agile & Framework Leadership: SAFe Framework & PI Optimization · Cross-Functional Team Leadership · SMART Objective Formulation · Data-Driven Process Optimization

Release Governance & Execution: End-to-End Release Scheduling · Production Change Management · Risk & Dependency Mitigation · Defect Lifecycle · Supplier Alignment

Stakeholder & Team Alignment: Executive Stakeholder Management · Cross-Departmental Communication

Professional Experience

Role: Release Train Engineer (RTE)

Company: MSI Experts | Airbus Cybersecurity

Date: July 2024 – Present

Location: France

Focus: Setting up how the teams work together and keeping our strategy on track.

Serving as the central Agile authority for four cross-functional Cybersecurity teams across three countries. Responsible for architecting end-to-end Agile governance and driving delivery excellence.

- **PI Optimisation:** Orchestrated a total re-architecture of PI Planning; eliminated redundant overhead, compressing a 3-day event into a single high-impact day (66% efficiency gain) while increasing stakeholder alignment.

- Strategic Alignment: Partnered with leadership to realign Epics and Capabilities, accelerating roadmap execution and achieving an 86% success rate (478 of 557 objectives delivered).
- Governance & Scaling: Established a robust framework to decompose high-level strategy into 11,261 actionable user stories; normalized capacity planning and velocity across 89 iterations to instill high-predictability delivery across the ART.

Role: Scrum Master

Company: Amaris | Airbus Cybersecurity

Date: September 2019 – June 2024

Location: France

Focus: Keeping our delivery pipelines moving and helping the different teams hit their goals.

Directed delivery pipelines for four high-impact functions: Software Maintenance, Detection Engineering, Operations/Run Request Management, and Organisational Data Compliance.

- Agile Governance: Orchestrated core Agile ceremonies and managed end-to-end iteration lifecycles for four teams from initial capacity planning and story refinement to tracking delivery, mitigating risks, and reporting on velocity. Directed over 2,000 daily standups to maintain team alignment and rapid resolution of impediments.
- Vendor & Stakeholder Management: Led weekly synchronization with cybersecurity vendors to resolve bugs and feature requests. Chaired department-wide showcases, ensuring leadership alignment on risk reduction and business value.
- Release Governance & Operations: Directed the Change Advisory Board (CAB) pipeline; oversaw 1,202 production deployments and resolved 1,155 technical defects, maintaining operational stability and a zero-incident deployment culture.
- Operational Optimization: Standardised departmental workflows, authored critical operational communications, and managed cross-functional PI-cycle logistics to ensure continuity across diverse team functions.

Role: Implementation Lead (SaaS)

Company: Invesco

Date: 2015 – 2019

Location: France

Focus: Helping major financial institutions get the most out of our software and making sure our implementation projects actually crossed the finish line.

- End-to-End Implementation: Owned the full project lifecycle for major banks, investment firms, and insurers. Managed 6–12 month projects by translating complex client needs into technical configurations that actually worked for their business.
- Bridging Business & Tech: Acted as the go-between for clients and developers. I took high-level client goals and turned them into clear requirements, ensuring the development team built what the client actually needed, not just what was requested.
- Project Governance: Cut through project clutter by setting up simple, clear frameworks for project charters, risks, and internal roles, making it easy for teams to know exactly what needed to get done and when.

- Operational Problem Solving: Managed multiple implementation projects at once. I kept things moving by identifying bottlenecks early and coordinating between internal support teams and client stakeholders to keep momentum high.
- Product Growth & Advocacy: Served as the voice of the customer. I drove product adoption and identified new opportunities by listening to client feedback and using that data to help shape future product strategy.

Role: Product Owner (Digital Wealth Management)

Company: Jemstep

Date: June 2012 – December 2014

Location: South Africa

Focus: Pivoting and scaling a B2B2C SaaS platform.

- Strategic Pivot: Led the transition of a wealth management platform from B2C to an enterprise B2B2C SaaS model for major US investment advisors.
 - Product Lifecycle & Design:
 - Owned the end-to-end product value stream (Research → Design → Build → Test → Measure → Iterate), leveraging story mapping and detailed backlog grooming to translate user journeys into precise engineering specs.
 - Global Team Leadership: Directed product delivery across five distributed squads (US, South America, South Africa, India) using hybrid Agile/Waterfall frameworks.
 - Stakeholder & Quality Governance: Acted as the central product authority for prioritization and scope, enforcing strict quality gates via UAT and KPI tracking to drive continuous iteration.
 - Enablement: Drove organizational adoption through company-wide product training and client demonstrations.
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Technical Toolkit

Agile & Portfolio Management: Jira, VersionOne, ZohoSprints

Facilitation & Documentation: Confluence, Klaxoon

Automation & Scripting: Google Apps Script (JavaScript), API integrations, Advanced Excel/Sheets (Pivot Tables, Query)

DevOps & Version Control: GIT, GitHub

Collaboration: Google Workspace, MS Teams, Slack

Education & Certifications

Scrum.org: Professional Scrum Master (PSM I)

Wits Business School: Postgraduate Diploma in Management (PDM)

University of the Witwatersrand: Certificate in Project Management

Damelin: Bachelor of Commerce (BCom) in Marketing & Business Management
